MKTG3112 Marketing Communications · Individual Essay

Alo in Australia – Reflection and Alternative Approach

Student number [ ]

Word count. Question One 697, Question Two 1052 (headings and body text, excluding figures, notes, prompts, references and appendices). Total 1,749

Question One – Evaluating “Mat to Moment”

1.1 Overall Assessment

Campaign effectiveness means achieving intended outcomes, not reach or likes (Belch & Belch, 2021). Against our four objectives, Mat to Moment would lift store awareness (O3) but is least likely to achieve perceived worth (O1), the objective we ranked first (Appendix A). Our DAGMAR objectives were a strength, being specific, measurable and tied to diagnosed challenges (Colley, 1961).

1.2 Target Audience

Segment A was still the right audience, as its members treat activewear as an extension of their identity (Belk, 1988). However, these women are also under financial pressure, with over half of their generation delaying major decisions (Deloitte, 2026), a tension we never resolved. At A$100–200 per item, Alo is “masstige” rather than luxury, and new-luxury buyers trade up in valued categories while cutting back elsewhere (Silverstein & Fiske, 2003). We followed Kapferer and Bastien’s (2009) rule that luxury needs meaning rather than justification, but stretched buyers need justification, as guilt suppresses indulgent purchases unless the expense feels worthwhile (Okada, 2005).

1.3 Message Design

Our line, “From Mat to Moment”, was clear, and its calm after-class moments broke from rivals’ focus on sweat, a sign of divergent, creative advertising (Smith & Yang, 2004). However, it promises activewear worn from class to the rest of the day, which is what athleisure means (Merriam-Webster, n.d.), and our own report notes that P.E Nation sells leggings the same way (P.E Nation, n.d.). Because any rival could run our line, viewers may forget it was Alo, risking our 60% brand-

attribution target. Our price argument is also weak. Most people see only bus panels and Instagram posts, where Worth it is an “instructor-tested” label, a peripheral cue (Petty et al., 1983) that claims quality but never explains why Alo costs A$100–200. The full case appears only on product pages, in stores and at 36 sessions reaching a few hundred. Attitudes formed from peripheral cues are weaker and fade faster (Petty & Cacioppo, 1986), so O1, our top objective, depends on the channels reaching the fewest people.

1.4 Channel Selection

Seven touchpoints suit our budget, but the split weakens reach. Outdoor, at A$55,000 (22%), is our largest cost, yet outdoor has low audience selectivity (Belch & Belch, 2021), so much of that money reaches people outside our segment. With only 43% of spend buying paid media, reaching 70% of the segment in Burst 1 is tight. Concentrating spend on Instagram and TikTok would deliver more reach, as Australian Android users spend about 74 minutes a day on TikTok (Kemp, 2026).

1.5 Integration

Integration is our plan’s main strength. Every touchpoint carries the same line, set and sign-off, and only the hook and call to action change, giving consistent meaning without identical executions (Batra & Keller, 2016). However, its order is inconsistent. Our objectives assume that, for fashion, people feel before they weigh up facts (Vaughn, 1980), yet our journey follows AIDA, which saves the price argument for the Desire stage in Burst 2 (Strong, 1925). So most people would learn where our stores are but never why Alo is worth the money. Integration also rests on one lead creator, and creators are high-impact but low-control touchpoints (Duncan, as cited in Belch & Belch, 2021).

1.6 Likely Effectiveness and Measurement

I expect O3 to succeed, as one fact repeated near stores suits peripheral learning (Petty et al., 1983). O2 is plausible, as localising through Sydney sources, one of our best decisions, adds relational value (Sichtmann et al., 2019). O1 is at risk, and O4 depends on it, because behaviour follows attitude (Vaughn, 1980). Our post-testing is honest but partial. Holdouts measure incrementality only for paid social, 21% of spend, while the rest is judged on before-and-after change, which can overstate effects (Gordon et al., 2019). With about 400 respondents, only five-point changes are reliable, so our six-point attitude targets are barely detectable.

1.7 What I Would Change

I would therefore argue Alo's price openly in the media most people see, replace "From Mat to Moment" with an idea only Alo could own, and move money from outdoor and sessions into Instagram and TikTok, where results can be measured. Question Two develops these changes.

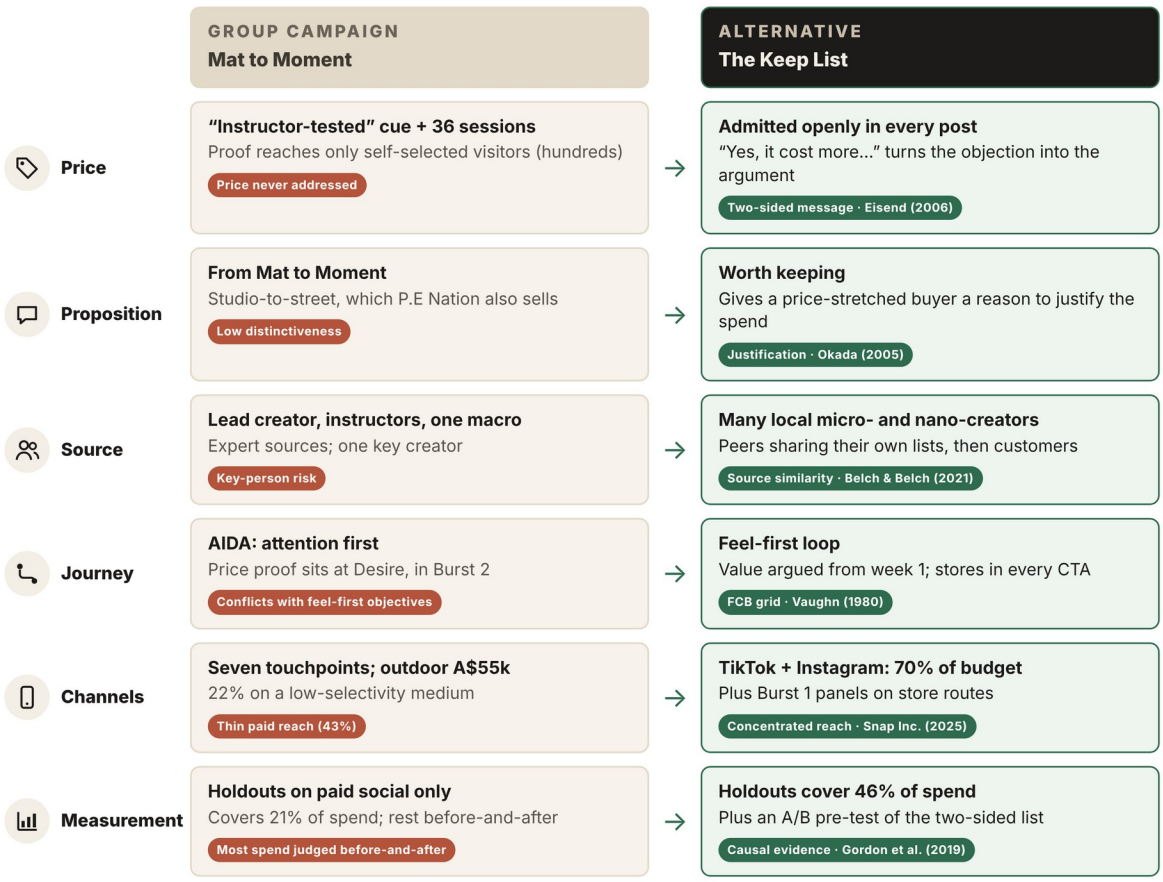
Question Two – An Alternative Approach, “The Keep List”

2.1 What I Changed and Why

The Keep List keeps Segment A, objectives O1–O4 and the A$250,000 budget but changes how we communicate, each change answering a weakness from Question One (Figure 1). Because price was our biggest unresolved problem, perceived worth (O1) becomes the lead objective.

Figure 1

What Changes From the Group Campaign



Note. Weaknesses come from Question One, and tags show the main source justifying each change.

2.2 Audience and Insight

I keep Segment A because its identity-driven buying still fits Alo best (Belk, 1988), and the price tension from Question One is a message problem, not an audience problem. What I change is the

insight. Financially pressured young consumers are not cutting back quietly. In 2024, “loud budgeting”, openly naming what you will not spend on, spread on TikTok as a statement of choice (Axios, 2024). My insight is that Segment A cuts back out loud, and what they keep says who they are. Alo’s positioning as premium activewear for the whole day stays, now expressed as “worth keeping” rather than “studio to street”.

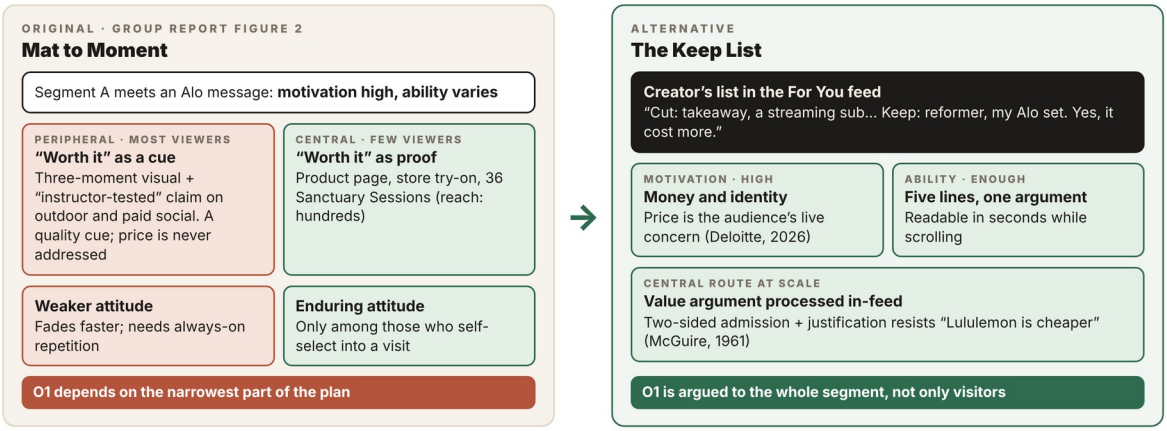
2.3 Message and Persuasion Route

Our original message praised quality without mentioning price. Mine is two-sided, as creators admit Alo costs more, then explain why it is worth keeping. Admitting a drawback makes a source more credible (Eisend, 2006), and raising the price objection first inoculates viewers against later counter-arguments such as “Lululemon is cheaper” (McGuire, 1961). The list also supplies the justification our campaign lacked (Okada, 2005). Because, under mental accounting, consumers keep separate budgets (Thaler, 1999), placing Alo beside cancelled takeaway moves it from “fashion splurge” to “things I use every day” (Appendix B). Because peers, not Alo, discuss price and no discounts are offered, prestige is protected, as luxury brands should not discount or defend prices (Kapferer & Bastien, 2009).

Under the Elaboration Likelihood Model, people weigh an argument carefully only when motivated and able to (Petty et al., 1983). In our plan, that required a visit (Figure 2). A five-line list is read in seconds yet makes one clear argument on a topic this audience cares about, so the case for O1 reaches the whole segment.

Figure 2

Elaboration Likelihood Model, Before and After



Note. Adapted from Petty et al. (1983) and the group report's Figure 2.

2.4 Sources

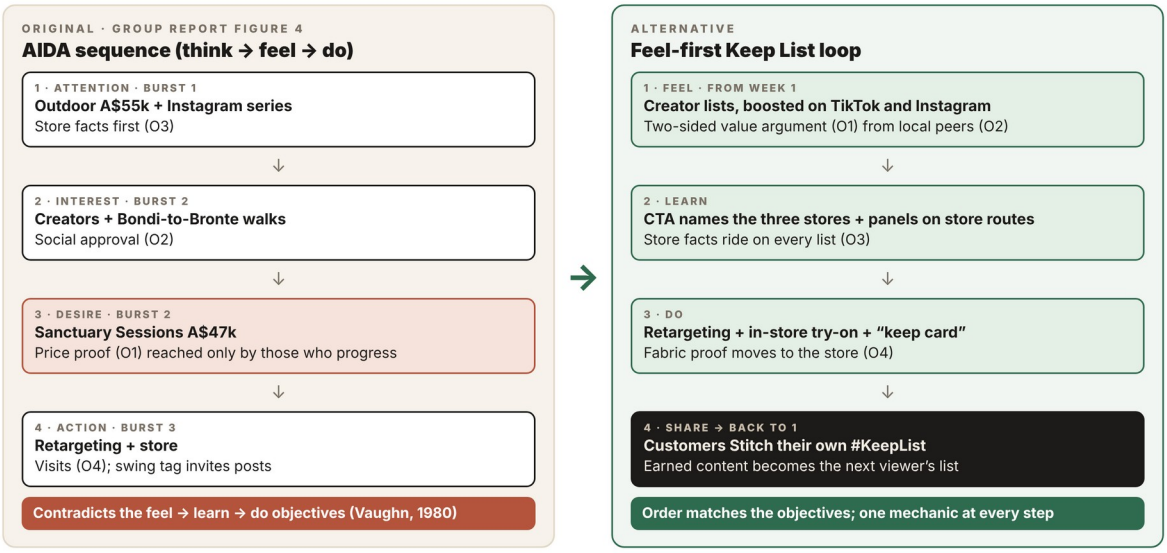
I replace our lead and macro creators with many Sydney micro- and nano-creators, and later customers, posting their own lists. Smaller creators achieve higher engagement and closer trust (Campbell & Farrell, 2020), similar sources are more attractive and persuasive (Belch & Belch, 2021), and no single creator can derail the campaign. As everyone uses one format, it becomes a distinctive brand asset, aiding attribution (Sharp, 2010).

2.5 Journey, Channels and Budget

Figure 3 replaces our AIDA journey with Vaughn's (1980) feel–learn–do order. Lists first build feeling (O1, O2) and end with the three store names (O3), while retargeting and in-store try-ons drive visits (O4). Customers then Stitch their own lists in reply, which become the next viewer's starting point, closing the advocacy loop (Court et al., 2009). Boosted as ads and reshared on Alo's channels, the same creator posts work as paid, owned and earned media (Stephen & Galak, 2012). In-store "keep cards" carry the format offline (Appendix C).

Figure 3

Consumer Journey, Before and After

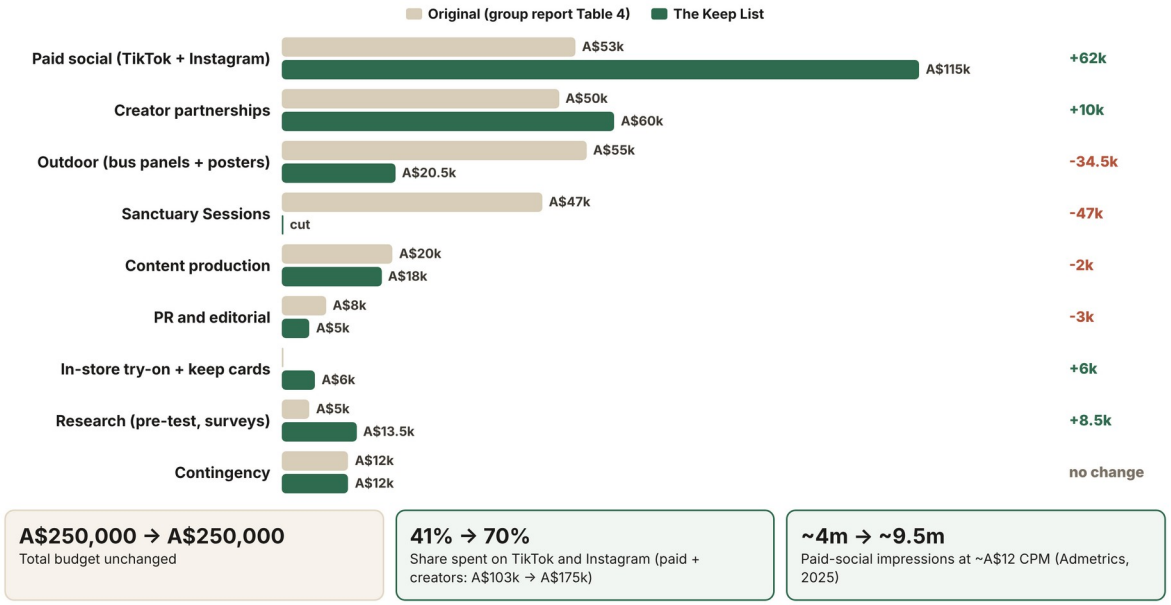


Note. Adapted from Strong (1925), Vaughn (1980), Court et al. (2009) and the group report's Figure 4.

Figure 4 reallocates the same A$250,000. I cut Sanctuary Sessions (A$47,000), which reached only a few hundred people, and reduce outdoor from A$55,000 to A$20,500 for Burst 1 panels on store routes. TikTok and Instagram rise from A$103,000 to A$175,000, 70% of the budget. At about A$12 per thousand impressions (Admetrics, 2025), A$115,000 of paid social buys roughly 9.5 million impressions, more than double our original four million, mirroring Ben & Jerry's single-platform success (Snap Inc., 2025).

Figure 4

Budget Reallocation Within A$250,000

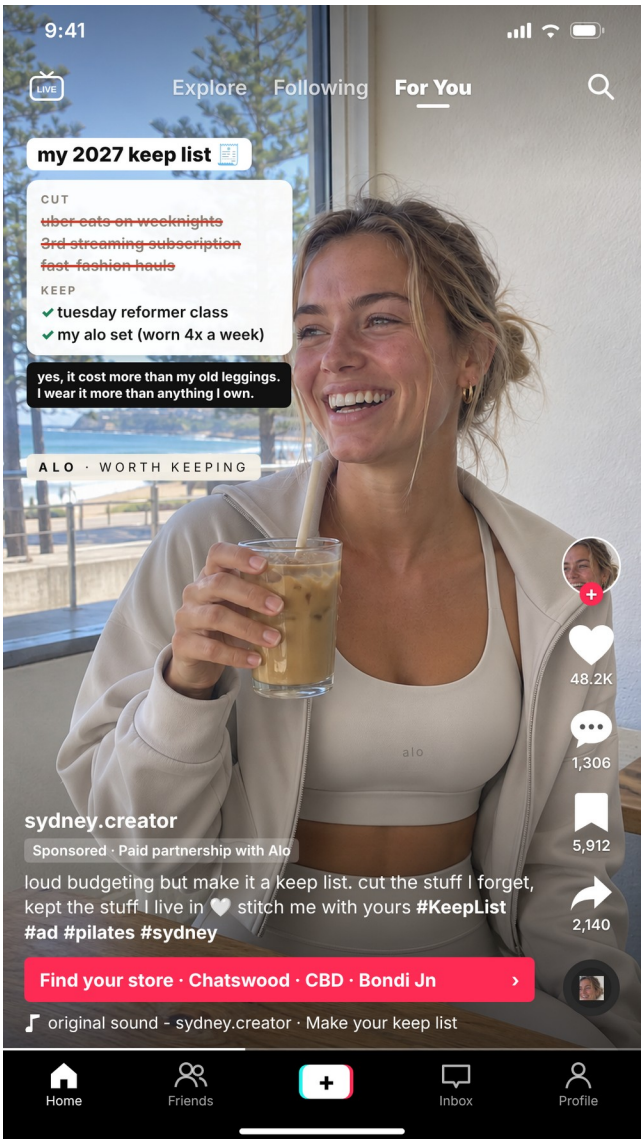


Note. Original figures are from the group report's Table 4. Bus panels cover 20 panels for three weeks at GoTransit (n.d.) rates plus production, with A$4,000 for posters. Creators cover about 100 micro and nano posts at A$150–750 each (Wise, 2025).

2.6 Creative Mock-up

Figure 5

“The Keep List” TikTok In-Feed Creator Post (Burst 1)



Note. AI-generated photograph composed into a TikTok frame. The person is not real, and the handle and engagement figures are illustrative. AI prompts used. (1) Photograph, generated with [name the image tool you used], using the prompt “Photorealistic vertical 9:16 smartphone photo that looks like a still from an iPhone TikTok video, not a professional shoot. A woman in her mid-twenties sits at a small timber table by the window of a casual café in Bondi, Sydney, around 9am, just after a reformer Pilates class. She wears a matching Alo Yoga–style set: a sleek, smooth sculpting sports bra and high-waisted leggings with a subtle sheen, in a soft neutral ‘bone’ colour, with an oversized cropped zip jacket in the same colour open over it. Clean, minimal, premium design. Do not render any text or logos on the clothing. Natural, unretouched skin, minimal makeup, hair in a slightly messy low bun, small gold hoop earrings. She is laughing naturally while holding an iced oat latte and looking just off camera. Soft morning sunlight comes through the window, with the ocean and Norfolk pines faintly visible and out of focus behind her. Handheld phone-camera look: slight

grain, true-to-life colour, shallow depth of field. Composition: she sits in the right half of the frame, shown from the waist up, with her face about 45% of the way down the image. Keep the upper-left third and the bottom quarter visually quiet so text overlays can sit there. No text, logos, watermarks or other people in focus." (2) TikTok frame, composed with Claude (Anthropic), using the prompt "Place this photo in an accurate TikTok For You in-feed Spark Ad frame (1080 × 1920 px) with the status bar, LIVE/Explore/Following/For You tabs, right-hand rail (creator avatar with follow button, likes, comments, saves, shares, sound disc), 'Sponsored · Paid partnership with Alo' under the handle, the caption with #KeepList and #ad, a red call-to-action button 'Find your store · Chatswood · CBD · Bondi Jn' and the sound line. Add native TikTok text overlays in the empty window area: 'my 2027 keep list', a Notes-style list (CUT: uber eats on weeknights; 3rd streaming subscription; fast-fashion hauls, struck through; KEEP: tuesday reformer class; my alo set (worn 4x a week)), the aside 'yes, it cost more than my old leggings. I wear it more than anything I own.' and an 'ALO · WORTH KEEPING' sticker. Add a small, correctly spelled 'alo' wordmark on the sports bra. Keep every overlay clear of her face."

Media format. Figure 5 is the opening frame of a 15-second TikTok Spark Ad, a boosted creator post in which the list builds line by line beneath her voice-over.

Message. The list is the argument, with three things cut, two kept, then the admission "yes, it cost more than my old leggings". The sign-off "Alo. Worth keeping." attaches the justification to the brand. It persuades because it argues value in the audience's terms, not the brand's.

Imagery. A woman in her mid-twenties laughs over an iced latte in a beachside Sydney café after class in the matching set. Natural light, unretouched skin and a handheld look suit Gen Z's preference for authenticity (Francis & Hoefel, 2018), making the endorsement believable, while the local setting supports O2.

Design. Native TikTok text makes the post read as creator content, while Alo's neutral palette, wordmark and sticker preserve brand linkage. "Sponsored · Paid partnership" sits under the handle and #ad in the caption, because advertising must be clearly distinguishable, especially in native formats (Australian Association of National Advertisers [AANA], 2021; Wojdynski & Evans, 2016).

Call to action and engagement. "Find your store" names Chatswood, the CBD and Bondi Junction (O3, O4), while the caption invites viewers to Stitch their own list. As loud budgeting is already shared publicly (Axios, 2024), replying feels natural, and each reply carries the message into peers' feeds.

AI limitations. My AI-generated photograph is believable but too polished for phone footage, and audiences tend to see artificial personas as uncanny and "authentically fake" (Lou et al., 2023). It also cannot reproduce Alo's garments or logo, so I added the wordmark. Its single slim model cannot show our segment's range of bodies, weakening relevance. In execution, real creators must wear

real Alo and list genuine trade-offs, as scripted personal claims would mislead (Competition and Consumer Act 2010 (Cth) sch 2 s 18).

2.7 Measurement

I would pre-test the two-sided list against a one-sided version on brand attribution and agreement that “Alo is worth paying more for” (Belch & Belch, 2021). Post-testing would use brand-lift holdouts to isolate incremental effects (Gordon et al., 2019) across 46% of spend rather than our 21% (Appendix D).

2.8 Advantages, Limitations and Expected Effectiveness

Compared with our original, The Keep List argues price to the whole segment, gives Alo an ownable idea and doubles paid reach on the same budget. It has two limitations. First, financial hardship is a recognised source of consumer vulnerability (Australian Competition and Consumer Commission [ACCC], 2021), and manipulation undermines normal decision-making (Sher, 2011), so lists must celebrate what people cut and never present the set as a necessity. Second, losing sessions and walks sacrifices hands-on proof and press coverage that try-ons only partly replace. Overall, I expect stronger O1 and O2, similar O3, and store-dependent O4 results.

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Appendix A

Figure A1

Evaluation of "Mat to Moment" Against Its Objectives

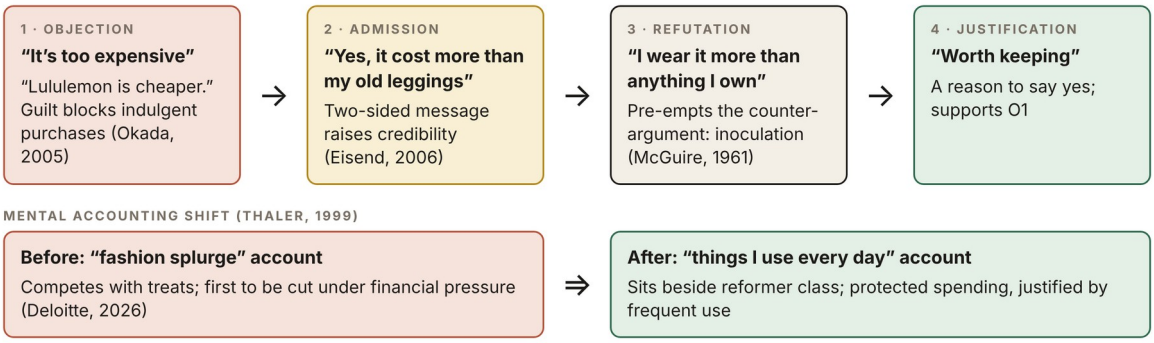
Objective	Main mechanism in the group plan	Evaluation	Likely outcome
O3 Learn: aware of Sydney stores (25% → 35%)	Store names on outdoor (A$55k) and the Instagram series in Burst 1	A simple fact suits peripheral learning (Petty et al., 1983); repetition builds memory (Keller, 2001)	Likely Strongest objective
O2 Feel: "a brand for people like me in Sydney" (12% → 18%)	Sydney instructors, creators and settings re-encode the LA brand	Localness adds relational value (Sichtmann et al., 2019); target sits near the ~5-point survey limit	Possible
O1 Feel: "worth paying more for" (15% → 21%)	"Instructor-tested" cue on reach media; proof in sessions, product pages and stores	Cue never addresses price; central route reaches self-selected visitors only (Petty & Cacioppo, 1986); guilt unaddressed (Okada, 2005)	At risk Top priority, weakest mechanism
O4 Do: visited store or site (8% → 11%)	Retargeting, session bookings, store CTAs	Behaviour follows attitude (Vaughn, 1980), so depends on O1	Uncertain

Note. My evaluation, supporting Question One.

Appendix B

Figure B1

Two-Sided Message Structure, Inoculation and Mental Accounting

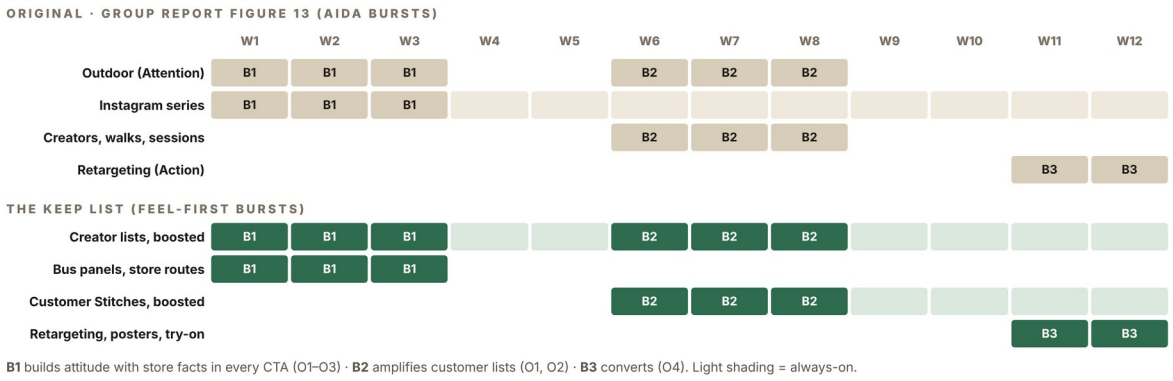


Note. Adapted from Eisend (2006), McGuire (1961), Okada (2005) and Thaler (1999).

Appendix C

Figure C1

Pulsing Schedule, Before and After



Note. Adapted from the group report's Figure 13, with pulsing from Belch and Belch (2021).

Appendix D

Figure D1

Pre-Testing, In-Flight and Post-Testing Plan



Pre- and post-testing stages from Belch and Belch (2021); randomised holdout rationale from Gordon et al. (2019).

Note. Adapted from Belch and Belch (2021) and Gordon et al. (2019).